



# BAHIANS

## GRANDCHILDREN OF SLAVERY

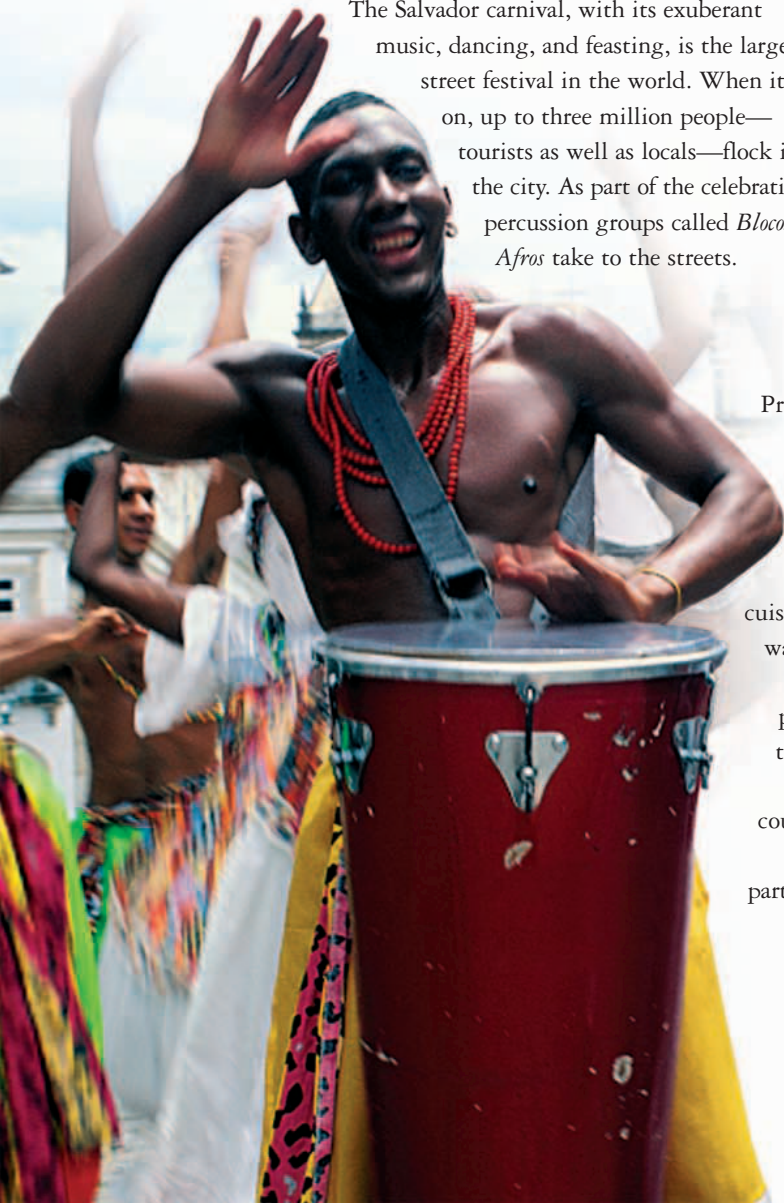
### CRUEL HISTORY

Salvador, Bahia's capital, was once the capital of Brazil. Its ultrafashionable Pelourinho district was originally named for the slave-beating sites located here—*pelourinho* means pillory, or whipping post.



### CARNIVAL

The Salvador carnival, with its exuberant music, dancing, and feasting, is the largest street festival in the world. When it's on, up to three million people—tourists as well as locals—flock into the city. As part of the celebrations, percussion groups called *Blocos Afros* take to the streets.



### Unique hybrid

There are more people of African descent in Brazil than in any other country except Nigeria, and most of them live in Bahia. While the region's culture is rooted in an African past, it has a uniquely seductive Afro-Brazilian identity that draws visitors from all over the world. Today, tourism is Bahia's leading industry.



### SUGAR CANE

Ropelike stalks of sugar cane are piled high in a Salvador market. For the workers, the task of harvesting canes is just as backbreaking as it was for their ancestors, as it is still largely done by hand with a machete.

### FOOD FOR FRIENDS

Preparing meals by hand is important, since every dish is believed to carry energy from the person who made it. Like many migrant cuisines, Bahian food was created from local produce prepared in the traditional style of the mother country. Here, fish and seafood are particularly plentiful.

